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FREE GUIDE

The 2-Minute Recording Checklist

Check these before you hit record. Two minutes of setup saves an hour of editing.

Setup

1. **Light in front of you.** Face a window or a lamp. Never sit with the window behind you.
2. **Phone at eye level.** Stack books if you need to. Looking down at the camera kills confidence.
3. **Clean background.** Nothing distracting behind you. Simple beats fancy.
4. **Quiet room, close mic.** People forgive average video. They never forgive bad audio.
5. **Phone on do not disturb.** Nothing ruins a great take like a notification.
6. **Lens wiped.** A smudged lens makes everything look soft.

While recording

1. **Look at the lens, not the screen.** It feels strange. On video it reads as eye contact.
2. **Say your first line twice.** Different energy each time. Your editor picks the better one.
3. **One idea per take.** If you go off topic, stop and start that answer again.
4. **Pause before and after.** Two seconds of silence at the start and end of each take makes editing easy.
5. **Energy one notch higher.** Camera flattens energy. What feels like too much usually looks right.
6. **Don't stop for small mistakes.** Pause, breathe, repeat the sentence. It gets cut.

If you hate watching yourself

- Almost every coach feels this at the start. It fades with practice.
- Don't watch the raw footage. Raw always looks worse than the edit.
- Record more than you need. The pressure drops when you know the best take gets picked.
- Post before you feel ready. Confidence comes after posting, not before.

Quick test before posting

Watch your video once on mute, on your phone, at full speed.

If you still understand it and you don't get bored, it's ready.

> Tape this page next to your camera.